



a home providing care for
the sick or terminally ill

Hospice: a new form of care

- The term hospice refers to a philosophy of providing care and comfort to **people in the dying process**
 - During the 1960s, British physician **Dr. Cicely Saunders** developed a modern approach to hospice that emphasized two approaches together: (compassionately caring for the dying)
 - professional caregiving
 - use of modern pain management
- Established St. Christopher's Hospice near London (foundation of all hospices in world)
- Evolved from (services in own location) to (other settings like hospital, nursing homes and even patient's home)
- Hospice services are available only to patients who have been attested by **two physicians** to be in the **last six months of life**.

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Services of Hospice

- **Knowledge about medical care and the dying process** by specially trained professionals, volunteers, and families working in a team approach
- Addressing all symptoms of diseases but with a special emphasis on **controlling a patient's pain and discomfort** and treating patients **with concern and dignity**
- Dealing with the **emotional, social, and spiritual** needs of patients and families
- Offering **bereavement and counseling** services to families before and after a patient's death

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Outcomes:

Based on research –

- Hospice care saves money (e.g.. Medicare saves more than \$2000 per person)...save more if admitted sooner...**but** the other side shows the impact of hospice care (family care and financial burden)
- Hospice clients survive an average of one month longer than those who receive ordinary medical care
- Hospice patients reported a higher quality of life, experienced less depression...(both supportive care and avoiding of traumatic treatments like surgeries and chemotherapies)

Hospices in India

Services provided:

- Hospice services shall comprise of an **interdisciplinary team** of physician, nurse, social worker, clinical psychologist and counselor available 24×7, all days of week including holidays.
- The team shall **coordinate with other staff** to provide dietary, physical, spiritual, services
- The team shall arrange **respite care and bereavement services for the family** to reduce care giver burden
- The care shall include administration of **drugs like opioids** for reduction of pain and other symptoms
- It shall include **laboratory and radiology** services and provide **continuum of services** (in different care settings)
- Hospice shall maintain clinical record including **documentation of care** coordinated by interdisciplinary team, conference meetings, telephone communications, after-hours contacts and actions
- Hospice interdisciplinary team shall **explain** the patient and family/care giver **the meanings of these documents** on an ongoing basis

Organization And Administration:

- ❑ Organization shall be **professionally and legally responsible** for all activities for providing hospice care
- ❑ **Registration**, regular or provisional or its **renewal** for a hospice organization shall be mandatory
- ❑ Governing Body shall **appoint** one or more staff such as physician, nurse, clinical psychologist, social worker, and others (dietician, spiritual counselor etc.)
- ❑ Governing Body shall set the **admission criteria** for patients requiring hospice care based on
 - (i) information provided by the family & a registered physician
 - (ii) application made on a prescribed form
 - (iii) an informed consent obtained from the patient or family
- ❑ In case the number of eligible applicants exceeds the number of places available, **preference shall be given** to more indigent and needy than the less indigent and needy, to more old than the less old and to the female than the male applicants
- ❑ No distinction shall be made on the basis of religion or caste

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□ Physical **facilities** shall be made available for hospice facility as per following guidelines

- (i) land and space to be commensurate with the size and extent of facility,
- (ii) safe and noise free premises with proper light including back up and proper ventilation.
- (iii) age-friendly and fire resistive construction (with NOC from Fire Department) and patient friendly nurses station
- (iv) clean water, hygienic toilets, clean clothing and linen
- (v) nutritious diet from a clean kitchen
- (vi) there shall be no sharing with any non-health entity.